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L1: IT Service Management (ITSM)

Services and practices 2025

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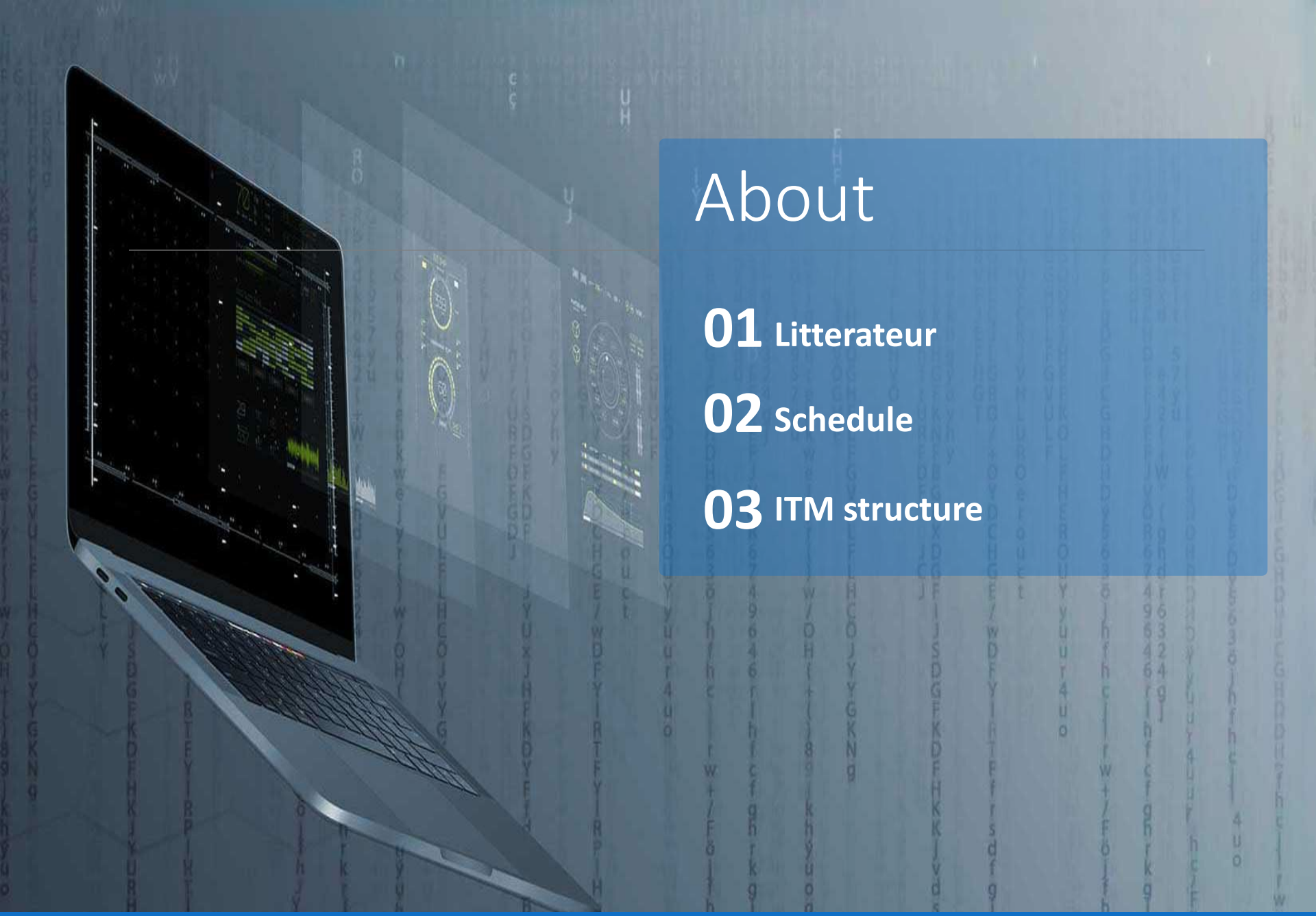

About

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ITSM: What is it?

IT Service Management

IT Management

Welcome to the island of IT

IT Service Management

From an IT Service Management perspective, IT is not an island, but a part of the “mainland” i.e., organization.

Until this fact is acknowledged and recognized on the organizational map, organizations will continue to struggle to generate value through IT.

An alternative perspective is to seek not to manage IT per se but to manage and to **enable value** through service(s); a subtle but profoundly different objective.

(Peppard 2007)

ITSM – A definition

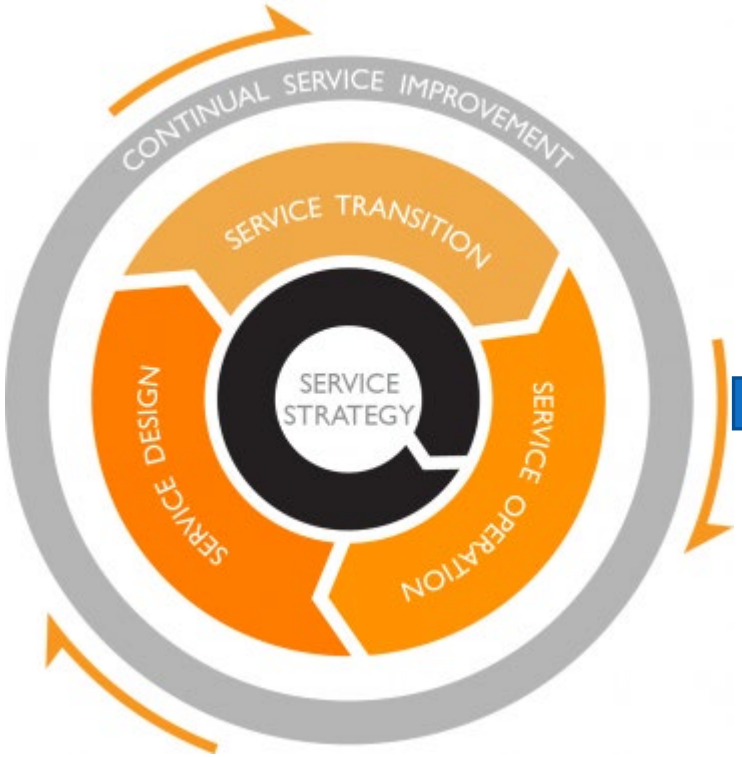
1. (IT) Service management is *"**a set of specialized organizational capabilities for enabling value for customers in the form of services**."* *(Agutter 2020)*

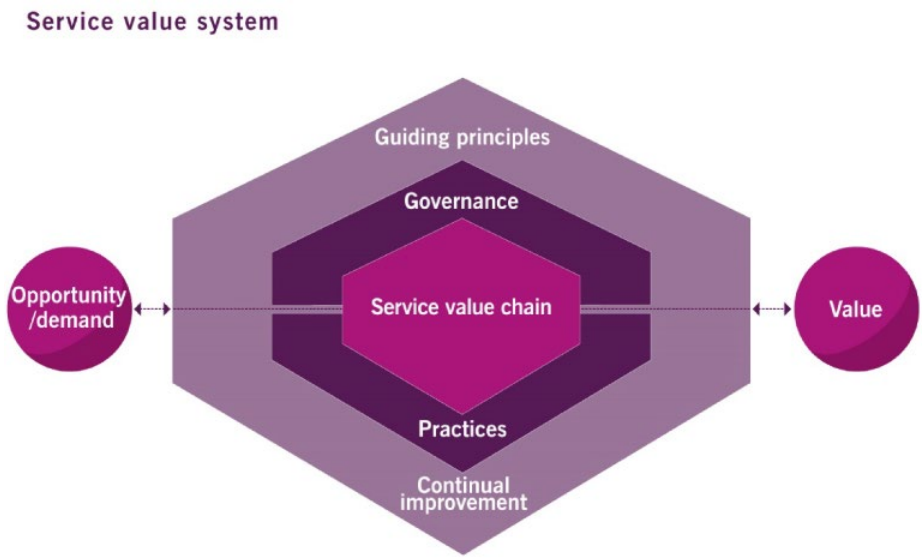
2. "**A structured and process-oriented approach to manage IT services where actors (e.g, people or institutions) in service ecosystems integrate and exchange resources (e.g., knowledge, skills, hardware, software) in order to co-create value propositions as well as enable value**." (Göbel 2021)

An organization can only develop these specialised organisational capabilities when it understands:

- The nature of value
- The nature and scope of the stakeholders involved
- How value creation is enabled through services

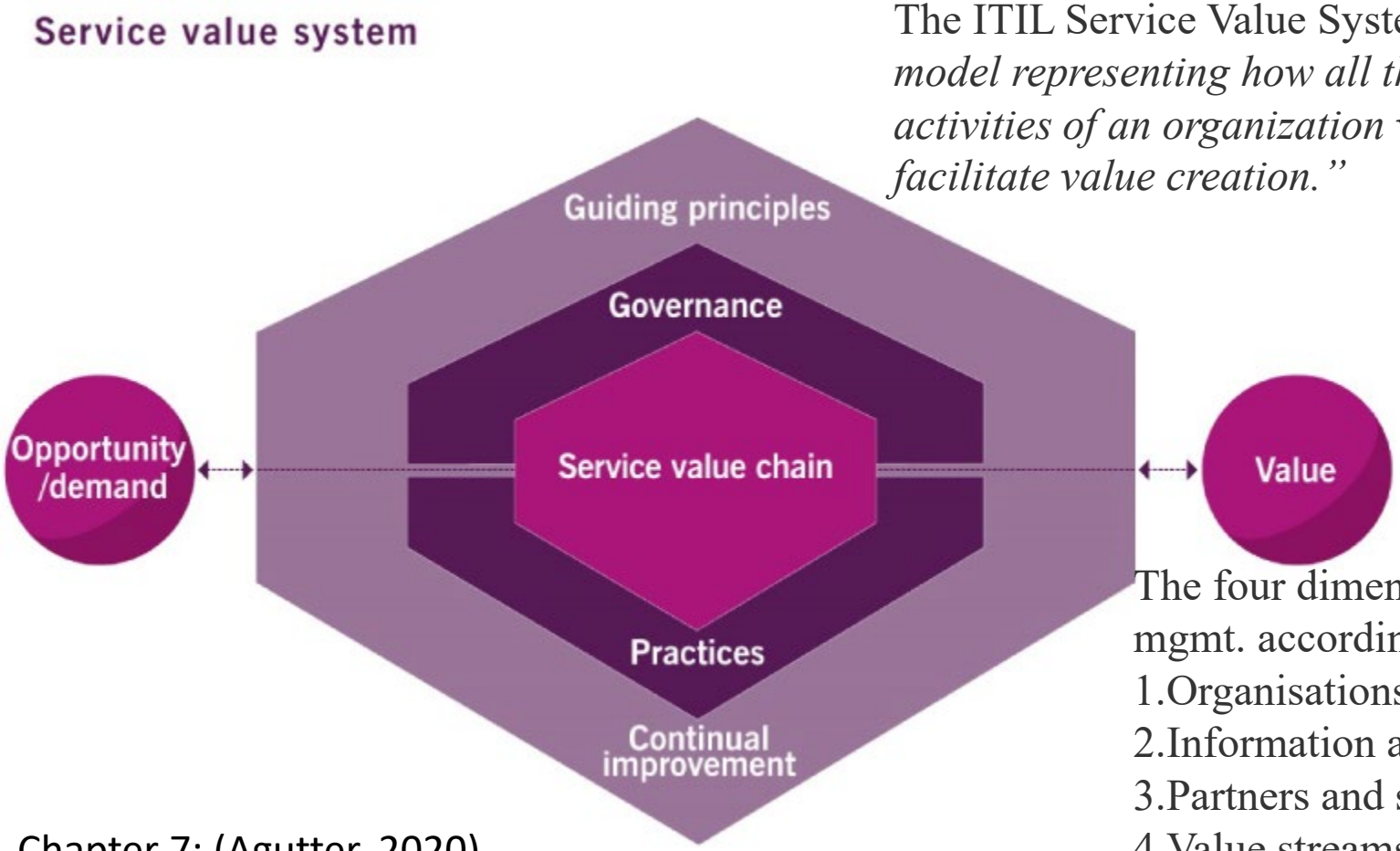
IT Service Management according to ITIL: From *Service Lifecycle* to *Service Value System*





ITIL is a set of practices and a framework for IT activities

ITIL 4: The Service Value System (SVS)



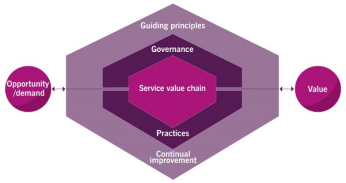
The ITIL Service Value System (SVS) is *"a model representing how all the components and activities of an organization work together to facilitate value creation."*

The four dimensions of Service mgmt. according to ITIL4 are:

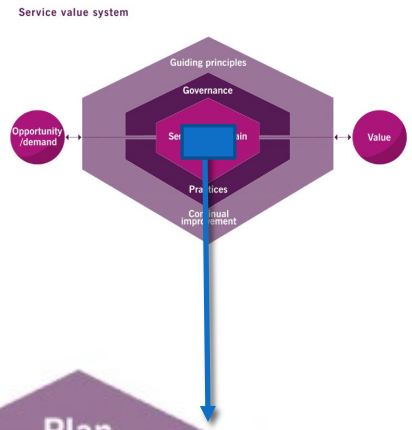
1. Organisations and people
2. Information and technology
3. Partners and suppliers
4. Value streams and processes

Chapter 7; (Agutter, 2020)

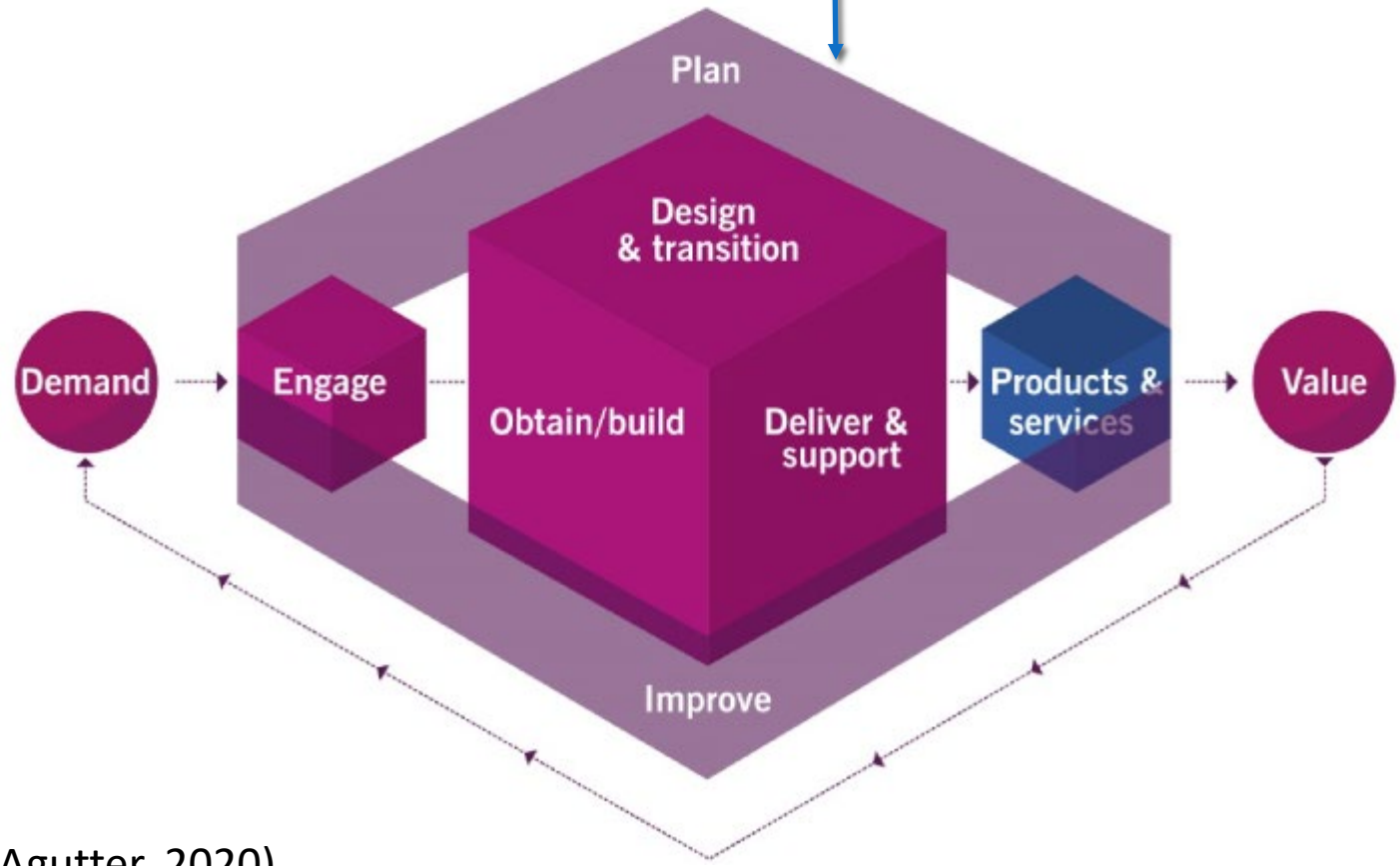
The Service Value System (SVS) include



Opportunity/ demand	Opportunities represent options or possibilities to add value for stakeholders or otherwise improve the organisation. Demand is the need or desire for products and services that originates from internal and external consumers.
Value	The outcome of the SVS is value. The SVS can enable the creation of different types of value for different stakeholders.
Guiding principles	The guiding principles are recommendations that can guide an organisation in all circumstances, regardless of changes in goals, strategies, types of work or management structure.
Governance	Governance is the means by which an organisation is directed and controlled. Governance activities include evaluate, direct and monitor.
Service value chain	The service value chain is a set of interconnected activities that an organisation performs in order to deliver a valuable product or service to its consumers and to facilitate value realisation.
Practices	The ITIL practices are sets of organisational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective.
Continual improvement	Continual improvement is a recurring organisational activity performed at all levels to ensure that an organisation's performance is always aligned to changing stakeholder expectations.

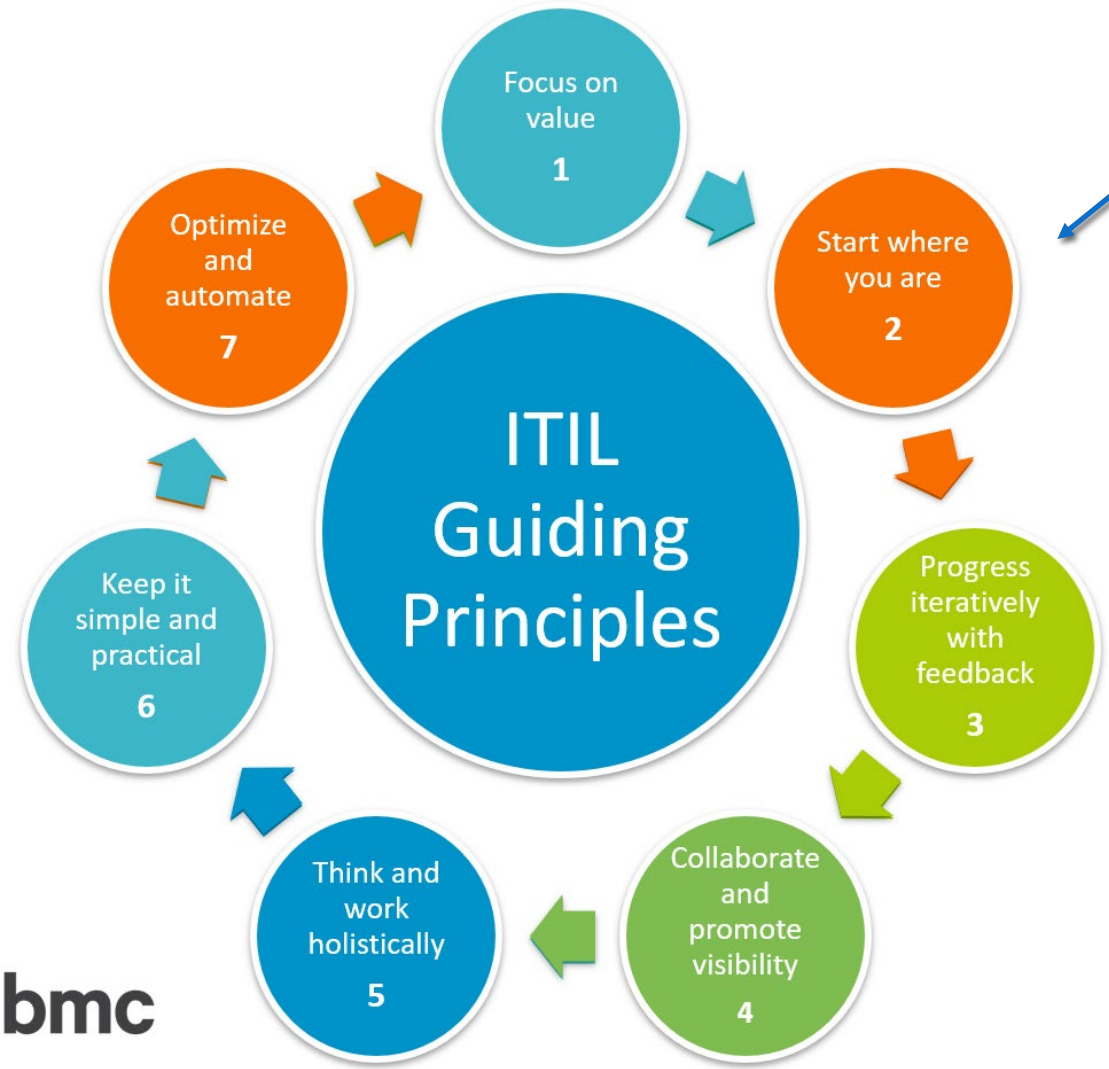


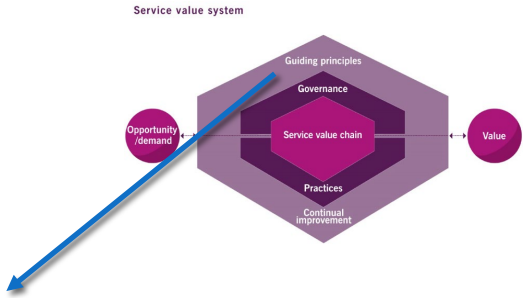
Service value chain



Chapter 7&8; (Agutter, 2020)

The 7 ITIL Guiding Principles





See also:
Chapter 5 (Agutter 2020)

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 1: FOCUS ON VALUE

"Everything the organization does should link back, directly or indirectly, to value for itself, its customers, and other stakeholders."

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- How consumers use each service – what do they value?
- How to encourage all of their staff to focus on value
- How to maintain a focus on value in day-to-day operations, not just as an improvement project
- How to embed focus on value in every single improvement initiative

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 2: START WHERE YOU ARE

Don't start from scratch and build something new without considering what you already have. *Change can be an evolution or a revolution. Revolution is more disruptive and can have unforeseen negative consequences. Before making any change or improvement, it's important to assess the current position and see if anything can be reused or built on.*

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- Being as objective as possible about what currently exists
- Assessing whether current practices and services can/should be replicated or expanded
- Using risk management skills during decision making
- Recognising that sometimes nothing from the current state can be reused

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 3: PROGRESS ITERATIVELY WITH FEEDBACK

"Resist the temptation to do everything at once. Even huge initiatives must be accomplished iteratively. By organizing work into smaller, manageable sections that can be executed and completed in a timely manner, the focus on each effort will be sharper and easier to maintain."

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- Comprehending the whole, but doing something; start small
- Seeking feedback because the ecosystem is always changing
- Going fast, which doesn't mean work is incomplete; iterations may be small, but they are still producing results

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 4: COLLABORATE AND PROMOTE VISIBILITY

Collaboration can be viewed as working together towards a shared goal. It can help to remove silos within organisations, allowing everyone to work together more effectively. Collaboration can happen anywhere – inside and outside of the organisation (for example: with other internal teams, or with external suppliers

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- Collaboration does not mean consensus; it's not essential that everyone agrees, but everyone must understand why decisions are made
- Communicating to match the audience: different stakeholder groups will need a different message and communication type
- Looking for visible data to support good decision).

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 5: THINK AND WORK HOLISTICALLY

"No service, practice, process, department or supplier stands alone. The outputs that the organization delivers to itself, its customers and other stakeholders will suffer unless it works in an integrated way to handle its activities as a whole, rather than separate parts. All the organization's activities should be focused on the delivery of value."

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- Collaboration supports holistic thinking and working
- Supporting holistic working with automation
- Identifying patterns in the needs of, and interactions between, system elements to help identify the holistic viewpoint

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 6: KEEP IT SIMPLE AND PRACTICAL

"Always use the minimum number of steps to accomplish an objective. Outcome-based thinking should be used to produce practical solutions that deliver valuable outcomes."

To successfully apply this principle, service providers need to consider:

- Ensuring value comes from every activity
- Simplicity can be more challenging to create than complexity
- Doing fewer things and doing them better
- Respecting people's time; don't make them do unnecessary work
- Simplicity can support quick wins
- Processes or services that are easy to understand are more likely to be used

GUIDING PRINCIPLE 7: OPTIMISE AND AUTOMATE

Optimisation means *"to make something as effective and useful as it needs to be. Before an activity can be effectively automated, it should be optimized to whatever degree is possible and reasonable".*

Optimisation can include:

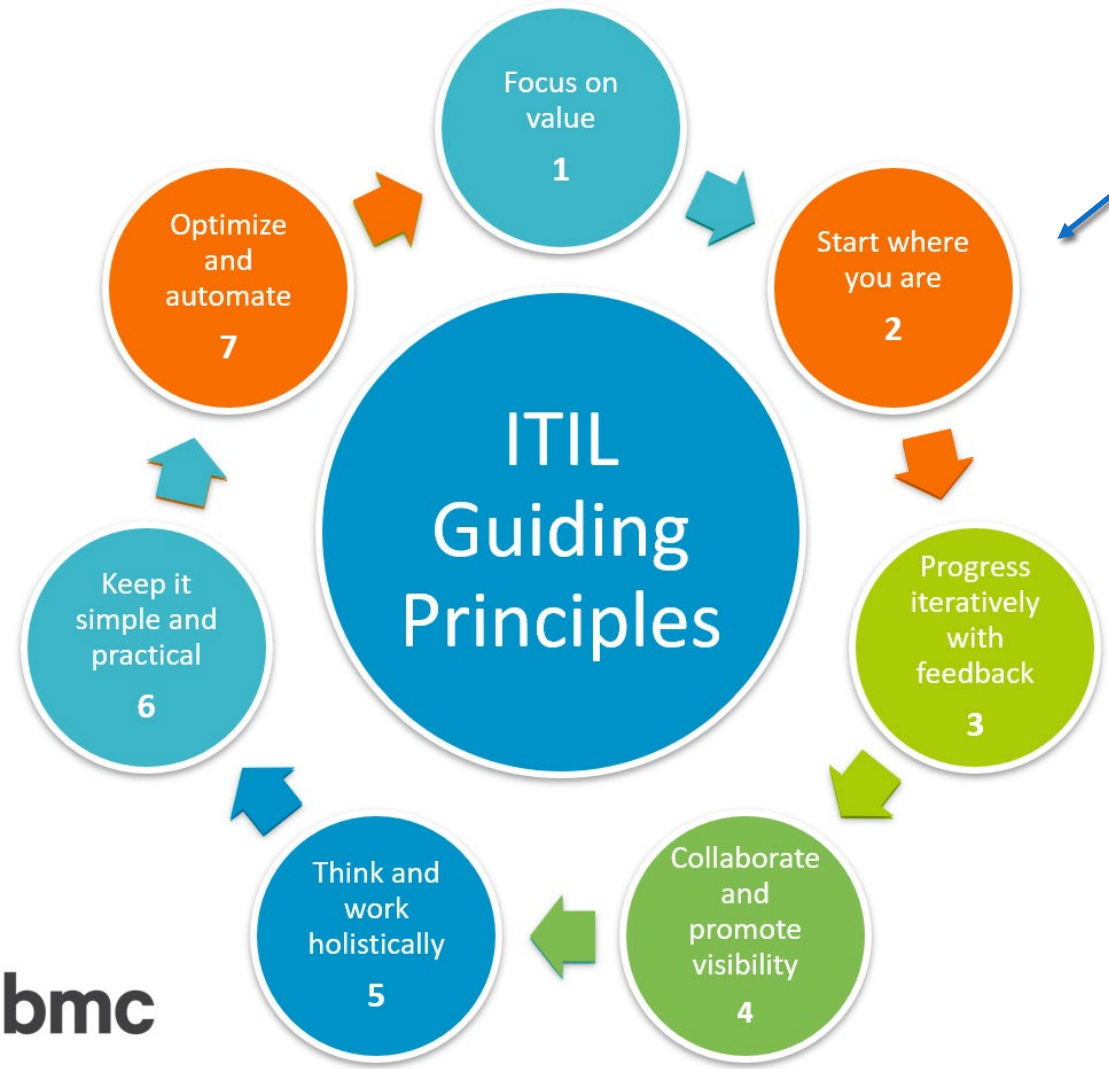
- Assessing the current state
- Executing improvements iteratively
- Continually monitoring the impact of optimisation

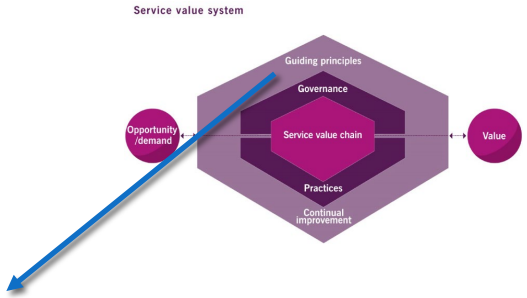
Automation typically refers to *"the use of technology to perform a step or series of steps correctly and consistently with limited or no human intervention."*

Automation can include:

- Focusing on tools supporting simplification
- Defining metrics to measure impact and value

The 7 ITIL Guiding Principles





See also:
Chapter 5 (Agutter 2020)

ITIL 4 Practices

“A practice is a set of organizational resources designed for performing work or accomplishing an objective.”

ITIL V3 defines 26 processes across the service lifecycle. In ITIL 4, these 26 processes have been replaced by 34 "practices“:

- 14 general management practices
- 17 service management practices
- 3 technical management practices

ITIL 4 is not prescriptive about processes, and **gives service providers more freedom to design tailor-made processes that work for the organization.** However, in this course we complement the knowledge about some practices from ITIL V3

ITIL 4 Practices

Category	Description
General Management Practices	These practices are adopted and adapted for service management from business management.
Service Management Practices	These practices have been developed in (IT) service management.
Technical Management Practices	These practices originated in technology management and have been adapted for service management

General Management Practices in ITIL4

1. Architecture Management
2. **Continual Improvement**
3. **Information Security Management**
4. Knowledge Management
5. Measurement & Reporting
6. Organizational Change Management
7. Portfolio Management
8. Project Management
9. **Relationship Management**
10. Risk Management
11. Service Financial Management
12. Strategy Management
13. **Supplier Management**
14. Workforce & Talent Management

Bold = important for the ITIL certficiation (i.e., not the same as the written exam in this course).

(IT) Service Management Practices in ITIL4

1. Availability Management
2. Business Analysis
3. Capacity & Performance Management
4. **Change Enablement**
5. **Incident Management**
6. **IT Asset Management**
7. **Monitoring & Event Management**
8. **Problem Management**
9. **Release Management**
10. Service Catalogue Management
11. **Service Configuration Management**
12. Service Continuity Management
13. Service Design
14. Service Desk
15. **Service Level Management**
16. **Service Request Management**
17. Service Validation & Testing

Bold = important for the ITIL certficiation (not the same as course exam).

Technical Management Practices in ITIL4

1. **Deployment Management**
2. **Infrastructure** & Platform Management
3. **Software Development** & Management

Bold = important for the ITIL certficiation (not the same as course exam).

itSMF International

The IT Service Management Forum

- itSMF is the only independent and internationally recognised forum for Service Management professionals worldwide.
- The not-for-profit organisation is a prominent player in the on-going development and promotion of Service Management 'best practice' standards and qualifications and has been since 1991, when the UK Chapter commenced as the founding Chapter.
- Globally, the itSMF now boasts over 6000 member companies
- 40,000 individuals spread over 50+ Chapters
- Why itSMF exist.
  - To create and sustain the global itSMF Member Community
  - To promote Service Management practices.
  - To raise the awareness of Service Management and how Service Management professionals benefit our global communities
  - Membership is free for students – see www.itsmf.se